



The Living Spiral

ON LIFE, ORDER, AND THE ARCHITECTURE OF FREEDOM

—The Two Ways to Build a World—

There are two ways to build a world. One begins with a ruler, a blueprint, and a grid. It assumes that order must be imposed, that life must be shaped by an external mind standing above it. This way builds in straight lines and right angles. It seeks certainty, control, and prediction.

The other way does not begin with a ruler or a blueprint. It begins with listening—to soil, to water, to wind, to roots, to the quiet intelligence of living systems. It does not ask, "What shall we force this place to become?" but rather, "*What wants to grow here?*"

THE BLOCK

Imposes order from above. Flattens hills, straightens rivers, replaces forests with plantations. Extracts, standardizes, dominates. Produces the illusion of order while seeding the reality of collapse.

Centralized. Rigid. Brittle.

THE SPIRAL

Emerges from below. Appears wherever life is allowed to breathe: in galaxies, seashells, tree rings, branching rivers, and the helix of DNA. No central planner designed these forms. From local interactions, a larger order arises.

Distributed. Adaptive. Alive.

*The spiral is not chaos. It is a higher order than the block can perceive. It is order that **remembers**—storing wisdom in its form, its pattern, its recursive self-similarity. DNA remembers billions of years of evolutionary problem-solving. A healthy forest remembers every drought, every fire, every season of abundance. The spiral's memory is distributed and alive. The block's memory is centralized and brittle.*

This is the same insight Hayek saw in free societies. Knowledge is scattered across millions of lives—like seeds across a forest floor—and no authority could ever gather it all into one commanding brain. A free market, at its best, behaves like a living ecosystem. A centralized state behaves like a plantation.

Forests thrive on diversity—thousands of species in a single square meter, each playing a role no planner assigned. When you clear them and plant a single crop, you do not improve on the

forest. You replace a living system with a dying one. You trade resilience for efficiency, and then discover that efficiency without resilience is just a slower form of collapse.

Not blocks. Spirals. This is not merely an aesthetic preference. It is a biological truth, an economic truth, and a political truth.

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—The Four Callings—

There are certain callings that have run through my family, each expressing a different part of what it means to live and create:

Film

Art Clokey

Gumby — Clay, Sets, Practical Effects

Through Gumby, he showed that media could be created through real craftsmanship: clay, sets, practical effects, and imagination made tangible.

Land

Joe Clokey

San Luis Video Publishing — Agriculture & Stewardship

Through San Luis Video Publishing, he worked to preserve and spread practical knowledge about agriculture and stewardship of the land.

Music

Joseph Walden Clokey

Classical Music & Education

As a professor of classical music, he devoted his life to teaching, cultivating excellence, and passing culture from one generation to the next.

Faith

Joseph Parkander

Augustana — Lutheran Ministry

As a Lutheran pastor at Augustana, he dedicated his life to conscience, faith, and the relationship between humanity and God.

These are all fields that have increasingly been overtaken by the machine. Yet each of these men sought to practice them in a living, human way—the way of the spiral rather than the block.

Together they point toward a single vision. Those who descend from them are not called merely to repeat one field, but to synthesize them together.

—The Order of Return —

When you realize that the thing you are called to do may eventually cost you everything, it does not mean you should abandon it. It means you should begin with principle.

Many people become influential before they are fully grounded in their principles. As they grow, they become more faithful to their conscience, and the very powers that once benefited from them begin to oppose them.

That is why my own order has been reversed.

First comes separation.

Then comes preparation.

Only afterward comes the return.

The foundation must be firm before the rise.

Many people build influence upon systems they later discover are corrupt. When they refuse to compromise any longer, they often lose the very support that made them successful. Yet those who oppose them fail to understand that a person's greatest influence may begin after they are gone. Their life becomes an example. Others continue what they started.

An imperfect person who remains faithful to conscience until the end becomes an inspiration because they chose what they believed was right instead of what was profitable. Whether every conclusion they reached was correct is not the point. The point is that they acted according to conscience rather than according to special interests or bribery.

When you see what someone refuses to sell, you begin to understand what they truly value.

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—The Living Order —

Creation is decentralized, yet unified. All things operate under a single higher order, not through domination, but through alignment. No part of creation stands above another. We are all souls—equal in worth, distinct in function—each operating within the same underlying law.

The great error begins when creation decides it can rule creation. In order to maintain control, it must destroy everything it cannot predict. It must prune all branches it cannot manage. It must force living timelines into rigid, controllable lines. It must destroy the spiral—and replace it with straight lines.

Life must be simplified in order to be controlled. But what is simplified too far ceases to live.

Then the restorer intervenes—not as a conqueror, but as a gardener. He does not seize control. He returns it to its rightful source. In doing so, he does not unleash chaos. He releases *life*.

Complexity is restored. Choice returns. Time becomes not a line, but a tree.

We were never meant to rule one another. We were meant to live as stewards—guided, not governed; differentiated, not divided. When no part claims the right to rule the rest, when all submit to the same higher law, the spiral returns. And life flourishes again.

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—Stewardship of Living Order—

Bioinformatics is the study of how life organizes itself—and that makes it, at its best, a form of stewardship. To steward life is not to treat organisms like machines. A machine is controlled from the outside. A living thing grows from within.

The genome is the written law of the organism. Natural genetic engineering is the continual revision of that written law. Conscience is the invisible hand of God that guides living systems toward God's concept of a plan while preserving the free will of the living.

Just as the invisible hand coordinates the decentralized choices of individuals into an economic order, conscience coordinates the decentralized actions of living beings into a living order.

A concept of a plan is not a rigid blueprint. It is a living order that adapts to the free choices of those who participate in it. God's plan is therefore not mechanical but living. It is not imposed upon creation; it unfolds through the voluntary actions of living beings.

In the same way that a free society cannot be engineered as one master plan, a living ecosystem cannot be engineered as one finished product. Both are too complex, too distributed, too alive. The appropriate posture in both domains is the same: build structures that support decentralized intelligence, preserve feedback, protect diversity, and allow self-organization to do what it does best.

Freedom is not the absence of order. Freedom is the possibility of living order.

The gate has no fence.

The true power is not in DC or Hollywood but in the minds of people who think freely according to conscience. Laws cannot be made. They can only be discovered by the local, distributed knowledge of conscience of the people. A camera, a microphone, a keyboard, and a conscience can reach farther than many institutions once imagined.

Life spirals. Empires block.

The spiral's memory is distributed and alive.

The block's memory is centralized and brittle.

That is the way of the spiral.

Things that are built break. Things that grow naturally return.

THE LIVING SPIRAL • THE LIVING AGE • CLOKEY PRODUCTIONS